

0.0.1 The Triple Knowledge (excerpt)

1. Thus apparently, O Vasettha, among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one brahmin who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one teacher of teachers who is able to see Brahma. Among any of the triple-knowledge brahmins, there is not even one in the seven generations of teachers who is able to see Brahma.

2. Apparently, even the ancient triple-knowledge brahmin seers, composers of the mantras, proclaimers of the mantras, this ancient mantra verses proclaimed and com-

tevijjasuttam (excerpt)

iti kira vāsetṭha natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekabrāhmaṇopi yena brahmā sakkehi diṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyopi yena brahmā sakkehi diṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ ekācariyapācariyopi yena brahmā sakkehi diṭṭho. natthi koci tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ yāva sattamā ācariyama-hayugā yena brahmā sakkehi diṭṭho -

yepi kira tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ pubbakā isayo mantānaṃ kattāro mantānaṃ pavattāro, yesamidaṃ etarahi tevijjā brāhmaṇā porā-

posed [by them], of which at present, the triple-knowledge brahmins chant, recite, rehearse, continuously repeating what was said, causing to pass down what has been recited, that is to say: Attaka, Vamaka, Vamadeva, Vessamitta, Yamataggi, Angirasa, Bharadvaja, Vasettha, Kassapa, Bhagu, even they do not speak thus: “We know thus, we see thus, how Brahma or when Brahma or where Brahma [appears].” Surely those triple-knowledge brahmins who speak thus: “We teach the path to union with that which we do not know, to that which we do not see, this is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to liberation, which practicing accordingly, leads to union with Brahma.”

ṇaṃ mantapadaṃ gī-
taṃ pavuttaṃ samū-
hitaṃ tadanugāyanti
tadanubhāsanti bhā-
sitamanubhāsanti
vācitamanuvācenti,
seyyathīdaṃ: aṭṭako
vāmako vāmadevo
vessāmitto yama-
taggi aṅgirasō bhā-
radvājo vāseṭṭho kas-
sapo bhagu, tepi na
evamāhaṃsu: maya-
metaṃ jānāma ma-
yametaṃ passāma
yattha vā brahmā
yena vā brahmā ya-
hiṃ vā brahmāti.
te vata tevijjā brāh-
maṇā evamāhaṃsu:
yaṃ mayaṃ na jā-
nāma yaṃ na pas-
sāma, tassa saha-
vyatāya maggaṃ
desema: ayameva
ujumaggo ayamañ-
jasāyano niyyāṇiko
niyyāti takkarassa
brahmasahavyatā-
yāti.

3. “So what do you think, O Vasettha, that being so, doesn’t the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be less than stellar?”

4. “Certainly, O Bhante, that being so, the statements of those triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be less than stellar.”

5. Good Vasettha. Indeed O Vasettha, that those triple-knowledge brahmins [could] teach a path to union with that which they do not know, that which they do not see, [claiming]: “This is the only straight path, this is the direct path leading to liberation, which practicing accordingly, leads to union with Brahma,” this possibility is not to be found. Just as, O Vasettha, a line of blind men go on in succession holding

taṃ kimmaññasi vā-seṭṭha, tanu evaṃ sante tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihī-rakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampajjati?ti.

addhā kho bho gotama, evaṃ sante tevijjānaṃ brāhmaṇānaṃ appāṭihī-rakataṃ bhāsitaṃ sampajjati.

sādhū vāseṭṭha. te vata vāseṭṭha tevijjā brāhmaṇā yaṃ na jānanti yaṃ na passanti tassa saḥavyatāya maggaṃ desessanti: ayameva ujumaggo ayamañ-jasāyano niyyāṇiko niyyāni takkarassa brahmasaḥavyatāyāti netam ṭhānaṃ vijjati. seyyathāpi vāseṭṭha andhaveni-paramparaṃ sam-sattā purimopi na

on to each other, the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. So too, O Vasettha, the statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins seem to me like a line of blind men; the first one does not see, the middle one too does not see, the last one too does not see. These statements of the triple-knowledge brahmins turn out to be mere speech, turn out to be mere words, turn out to be simply empty, turn out to be simply hollow.

passati majjhimopi
na passati pacchi-
mopi na passati, eva-
meva kho vāseṭṭha
andhavenūpamaṃ
maññe tevijjānaṃ
brāhmaṇānaṃ bhā-
sitaṃ. purimopi na
passati. majjhimopi
na passati. pacchi-
mopi na passati. te-
samidaṃ tevijjānaṃ
brāhmaṇānaṃ bhāsi-
taṃ bhassakaññeva
sampajjati, nāmakañ-
ñeva sampajjati. rit-
takaññeva sampaj-
jati, tucchakaññeva
sampajjati.

